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N° 16

COLLECTION
SELLERS

Express Home Staging

Small changes, big impact: prepare your home to impress from the first visit.



2026 EDITION

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important notice

This guide is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It presents general information about real estate in Quebec and does not constitute personalized real estate, legal, tax or financial advice. Every real estate situation is different, and you should consult the appropriate professionals before making a decision about a transaction.

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COLLECTION SELLERS · GUIDE NO. 16

Express home staging

Getting your property sale-ready in a weekend, room by room, on a budget

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Home staging is not decoration: it's marketing. The goal is not to please YOUR tastes, but to allow as many buyers as possible to plan ahead - and to justify a better price, faster.

This guide gives you an express plan, room by room, achievable in a weekend and without a big budget. Simple gestures with a strong impact.

Each chapter ends with a lined "My Notes" page to check off your tasks, piece by piece.

Home staging is not decoration: it is a sales strategy. Done right, it speeds up the sale and improves offers - often for a few hundred dollars. This guide goes to the essentials, piece by piece.

The golden rule: the buyer must plan ahead. We depersonalize, we purify, we highlight.

CHAPTER

The 3 principles that sell

> *Understand the logic before moving a piece of furniture.*

1. Declutter: fewer objects = larger and brighter rooms. This is the number 1 gesture, free and the most profitable.
2. Depersonalize: store family photos, memories and marked tastes so that the buyer imagines HIS life here.
3. Neutralize and clean: sober colors, thorough cleaning, neutral odors. An impeccable home inspires confidence.

Remember: we don't decorate for ourselves, we prepare a product for the market.

These three principles - declutter, depersonalize, highlight - explain almost the entire effect of home staging. The buyer must be able to project himself: the less he sees YOUR life, the more he imagines his own. And all this mostly costs time, not money.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *If you only do one thing: declutter massively. Empty 30% of your belongings (boxes in the garage or storage). The effect on the perception of space is spectacular and free.*

CHAPTER

Exterior and entrance: the first impression

> *Win over the buyer before they even enter.*

- Front: mowed lawn, trimmed hedges, cleared driveway, hidden trash cans.
- Entrance door: clean, handle that works, possibly a lick of paint.
- Interior entrance: clear, bright, welcoming (a mirror, a plant).

The first impression is made in a few seconds, from the sidewalk: it sets the tone for the entire visit.

The first impression is made before entering: clean facade, clear path, welcoming door. A neat exterior promises a well-maintained interior; a neglected exterior creates doubt from the sidewalk. A few hours of outdoor cleaning pays off big time.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Take a photo of your facade with your phone: the camera often reveals what the eye no longer sees (disorder, wear). Correct what the photo denounces.*

CHAPTER

Living rooms and kitchen

> *Highlight spaces that sell.*

- Living room: clear circulation, maximize light, a few neutral touches.
- Kitchen: almost empty counters, clean appliances, joints redone if necessary.
- Dining room: table set soberly to suggest conviviality.
- Light everywhere: working bulbs, open curtains, clear atmosphere.

The kitchen and the light are two decisive factors: invest your energy there as a priority.

The living rooms and the kitchen are the spaces that sell: clear the circulation, maximize the light, neutralize the decor and make the surfaces shine. A clean and uncluttered kitchen, even a modest one, is much more reassuring than a cluttered kitchen, even a high-end one.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Clear kitchen counters give an immediate impression of space and cleanliness. Put away everything except 1 or 2 decorative objects: it's one of the most effective gestures there is.*

CHAPTER

Bedrooms, bathrooms and finishing touches

> *Pay attention to intimacy and details.*

- Rooms: neutral and neat bedding, under the beds cleared, wardrobes decluttered (they appear larger).
- Bathrooms: spotless, clean matching towels, clean joints and taps, neutral odor.
- Final touches: repair anything that squeaks or gets stuck, ventilate, pleasant temperature on the day of the visits.

Details signal a maintained house: they reassure the buyer and reduce their attempts to negotiate down.

Rooms and bathrooms are sold by calm and cleanliness: neutral bedding, clear surfaces, clean joints, no traces. It is the details (smell, light, clear storage) that leave the impression of a healthy and well-kept house.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Partially empty your closets before visits: a half-full closet looks larger and suggests "lots of storage." Buyers always open the doors.*

CHAPTER

Big effect, small budget

> *Maximize impact without breaking the bank.*

Home staging does not require major work. The most profitable actions are often the least expensive:

- **Declutter** and depersonalize: free, and transformative.
- **Clean** in depth: an impeccable house appears better maintained.
- **Painting** fresh in neutral tones.
- **Light** : brighter bulbs, curtains open.
- Repair the **small defects** visible (handles, joints, taps).

A few hundred well-placed dollars can speed up sales and improve offers.

The most profitable is often the least expensive: declutter, clean thoroughly, refresh the paint in neutral tones, improve the lighting, repair small visible defects. If you only do one thing, declutter: an uncluttered home appears larger, brighter and better maintained.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *If you only do one thing, declutter. An uncluttered home looks bigger, brighter and better maintained - and it costs nothing but time.*

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

> *Your next steps, concretely.*

This week

1. Declutter 30% of objects (boxes to store).
2. Making the first impression: facade and entrance.

Within 30 days

1. Major cleaning, small repairs, optimization of light.
2. Prepare each room for photos and visits.

Then

1. Have professional photos taken once the house is ready.

My staging plan

1. Declutter and depersonalize each room, then clean thoroughly.
2. Refresh the paint in neutral tones and improve the lighting before photos.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Declutter: remove unnecessary objects to visually enlarge rooms.
- Depersonalize: neutralize the decoration so that the buyer can project themselves.
- First impression: perception created from the sidewalk.
- Neutralize: sober colors and a clean, bright atmosphere.
- Professional photos: step to take once the house is prepared.

- Declutter: remove excess objects to visually enlarge the space.
- Depersonalize: neutralize the decor so that the buyer can project themselves.
- Curb appeal: appeal of the facade and the entrance, the first impression.
- Neutral tones: sober colors that appeal to as many people as possible.
- Lighting: maximize natural light and warm lighting.

GO FURTHER

Quiz - test yourself

1. Home staging is above all:

A) Personal decoration

B) Marketing to help the buyer plan ahead

C) A major renovation

D) Useless

2. The n°1 gesture, free and the most profitable:

A) Repaint in bright colors

B) Declutter

C) Change the kitchen

D) Buy new furniture

3. Depersonalize means:

A) Add family photos

B) Put away memories and tastes that are too marked

C) Paint red

D) Put nothing away

4. The first impression is:

A) In the bedroom

B) From the sidewalk, in seconds

C) To the notary

D) After the sale

5. In the kitchen, a key gesture is:

A) Clutter the counters

B) Clear the counters almost completely

C) Hide the sink

D) Turn off the lights

6. Two deciding factors are:

A) The basement and the garage

B) The kitchen and the light

C) The attic and the cellar

D) Curtains only

7. Partially empty the wardrobes:

A) Makes them appear smaller

B) Makes them appear larger and suggests storage

C) Has no effect

D) Is prohibited

8. The careful details:

A) Encourages to negotiate hard on the downside

B) Reassure the buyer and limit negotiation

C) Do not matter

D) Make them flee

Answers

1. B - We prepare a product for the market (intro and chap. 1).

2. B - Fewer objects = more perceived space (chap. 1).

3. B - The buyer must imagine HIS life (chap. 1).

4. B - The facade sets the tone (chap. 2).

5. B - Immediate space and cleanliness (chap. 3).

6. B - We invest there as a priority (chap. 3).

7. B - Buyers open the doors (chap. 4).

8. B - They point out a maintained house (chap. 4).

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You now have the right keys in hand.

Every real estate journey is different.

If you would like to go further,
I would be happy to discuss
your project with you.



Make informed decisions.
Choose with confidence.
Live without regrets.
See you soon,
Emilie ☺

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